

Steven L. Finkelstein

CONTACT INFORMATION	The University of Texas at Austin Department of Astronomy 2515 Speedway, Stop C1400 Austin, TX 78712	<i>Office:</i> PMA 16.316 <i>Office Phone:</i> (512) 471-1483 stevenf@astro.as.utexas.edu www.as.utexas.edu/~stevenf
ACADEMIC POSITIONS	The University of Texas at Austin , Austin, TX Director, Cosmic Frontier Center Isabel McCutcheon Harte Centennial Chair (Fellow) Professor Associate Professor Assistant Professor	Fall 2023 – Present Fall 2023 – Present Fall 2022 – Present Fall 2017 – Summer 2022 Fall 2012 – Summer 2017
	The University of Texas at Austin , Austin, TX Hubble Fellow • Faculty Contact: Professor Karl Gebhardt	Sept. 2011 – Aug. 2012
	Texas A&M University , College Station, Texas Postdoctoral Research Associate • Faculty Advisor: Professor Casey Papovich	Sept. 2008 – Aug. 2011
EDUCATION	Arizona State University , Tempe, Arizona Ph.D. Physics, Emphasis in Astronomy • Advisor: Professor James E. Rhoads • Dissertation: Physical Properties and Dust Effects in High-Redshift Lyman Alpha Galaxies	August 2008
	University of Washington , Seattle, Washington B.S. Astronomy and Physics	June 2003
PUBLICATIONS	Summary: ~452 papers published in or submitted to peer-reviewed journals, with an h-index of 99. Of these, I am the lead author on 25 papers, which have ~4900 citations combined. Please see the full publication list starting on page 19 for details.	
HONORS AND AWARDS	• 2026-27 Chesley Lectureship, Carleton College • 2025 AAS Fred Kavli Plenary Lectureship • 2025 IOP Top Cited Paper Award • Class of 2025-26, UT Austin Academy of Distinguished Teachers • 2024 IOP Top Cited Paper Award • 2023 UT Austin Research Leaders Academy • 2020 UT Austin Provost's Teaching Fellowship • 2017-2018 Dads' Association Centennial Teaching Fellowship • 2017 Asa Briggs Visiting Fellow, University of Sussex • 2016 UT Austin College of Natural Sciences Teaching Excellence Award • 2015-2016 McDonald Observatory Board of Visitors Teaching Excellence Award • 2011 Hubble Prize Postdoctoral Fellowship	

AWARDED
GRANTS AND
FELLOWSHIPS

Summary: Total of \$11.3M awarded as PI since starting as faculty in 2012, inclusive of \$1.9M as Admin PI for grants led by students or postdocs under my supervision.

Roman Space Telescope Cycle 1 General Investigator Grant, \$1.2M (Finkelstein PI, Co-PI J. Muñoz)

- *Beating Cosmic Variance: UV Luminosity Functions and Clustering at Cosmic Dawn with Roman*

JWST Cycle 5 GO Grants, ~\$1,191,023 (Finkelstein Grant and Proposal PI)

- *MIRAGE: MIRI Investigation of Red and Ancient Galaxies in the Early Universe*, \$771,516 (**Finkelstein Grant and Proposal PI**, \$510,436 to UT)
- *The First Stars or the Last Stars: Confirmation of a Robust Candidate $z \sim 30$ Galaxy*, \$189,507 (**Finkelstein Grant and Proposal PI**, \$141,539 to UT)
- *VENUS: Vast Exploration of Nascent Unexplored Sources; Continuation*, ~\$230,000 (**Finkelstein Grant Co-PI, Proposal Co-I**)

JWST Cycle 4 GO Grants, \$685,914 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *VENUS: Vast Exploration of Nascent Unexplored Sources*, \$344,674 (co-led w/ J. Chisholm)
- *Searching for Population III stars around massive interacting galaxies in the reionization epoch*, \$87,147
- *SPAM: Star-formation from Photometry through the Addition of Medium-bands*, \$72,658
- *Balmer Breaks in Little Red Dots: Stellar Populations or Dense Neutral Gas?*, \$181,435

JWST Cycle 3 GO Grants, \$717,188 total (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *The CANDELS-Area Prism Epoch of Reionization Survey (CAPERS)*, \$346,964
- *MEOW: The MIRI Early Obscured-AGN Wide Survey*, \$177,208
- *COSMOS-3D*, \$43,545
- *Deep Spectroscopy of Galaxies at $z=4-14$: Uncovering Drivers of Early Galaxy Formation and Black Hole Growth*, \$59,703
- *A Spectroscopic Census of Faint, Broad-Line AGN at $z \lesssim 5$* , \$56,718
- *What really are the Physical Properties of Galaxies in the Epoch of Reionization?*, \$33,050

2022 UT Austin Spark Grant, \$200,000 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Solving Reionization with ERMOS on the Giant Magellan Telescope*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$309,297 (Finkelstein Co-PI),

- *NGDEEP: Next Generation Deep Extragalactic Exploratory Public Survey*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$60,301 (Finkelstein PI),

- *Confirming a Potential Ultra-Massive Galaxy at $z = 10.57$*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$96,103 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-PI),

- *The JWST-legacy narrow-band survey of H-alpha and [OIII] emitters in the epoch of reionization*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$59,727 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I),

- *PRIMER: Public Release IMaging for Extragalactic Research*

2021 NASA ADAP Grant, \$495,418 (Finkelstein PI; C. Casey Co-PI)

- *Leveraging Spitzer and VIRUS to Investigate Reionization and the Growth of Massive Cosmic Structures*

JWST Cycle 1 Early Release Science Grant, \$1.3M (Finkelstein PI, Individual grant \$430,470)

- *Cosmic Evolution Early Release Science Survey*

2020 NSF AAG Grant, \$229,660 (Finkelstein PI)

- *The Onset of Star-Formation Quenching in Massive Galaxies in the Early Universe*

2019 NSF AAG Grant, \$459,079 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Leveraging the Hobby Eberly Telescope Dark Energy Experiment to Understand Ly α Emission, Galaxy Evolution, and Reionization*

2019 Hubble Cycle 27 GO, \$49,720 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Confirmation of a Large, Robust Sample of $z=9-10$ Galaxies in the CANDELS Fields*

2019 Hubble Cycle 26 Mid-Cycle GO, \$29,909 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Photometric Confirmation of the Brightest Known Galaxy Candidate at $z > 9$*

2018 Hubble Cycle 26 GO, \$65,407 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *Ultraviolet Imaging of the Cosmic Assembly Near-infrared Deep Extragalactic Legacy Survey Fields (UVCANDELS)*

2018 Hubble Cycle 26 GO, \$15,525 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *The Low-Redshift Lyman Continuum Survey*

2017 NASA ADAP Grant, \$223,101 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Reference UV Luminosity Functions for the JWST Era*

2016 NSF AAG Grant, \$374,992 (Finkelstein Co-PI, individual grant \$145,914)

- *Collaborative Research: Galaxy Growth in Different Environments from $z=1.9$ to 3.5*

2016 WFIRST Science Investigation Team Award, Expected 5-year award: \$156,436 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *Studying Cosmic Dawn with WFIRST*

2015 NSF AAG Grant, \$417,386 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Spectroscopic Probes of Reionization and Galaxy Evolution in the First Billion Years*
- Includes two MPS-GRSV NSF supplements

2015 NASA ADAP Grant, \$287,245 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Probing the Build-Up of Quiescent Galaxies at $z > 3$*

2015 NASA ADAP Grant, \$93,926 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Searching for the Brightest Galaxies in the Distant Universe*

2015 Hubble Cycle 23 GO, \$106,934 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Lead Co-I)

- *CLEAR: CANDELS Lyman-alpha Experiment at Reionization*

NASA 2015B Keck Solicitation, \$13,000 (Finkelstein PI)

- *A Comprehensive View of Reionization: An Equivalent Width Limited Survey for Lyman Alpha Emission at $z=6-8$*

2015 Cycle 10 Spitzer Space Telescope GO Grant, \$10,000 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Searching for the Brightest Galaxies in the Distant Universe*

2014 NASA ADAP Grant, \$119,129 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Constraining Feedback at High Redshift with Spitzer Observations of GOODS-N and Abell 2744*

2014 Hubble Cycle 22 GO, \$127510 (Finkelstein Grant PI, Proposal Co-I)

- *FIGS: The Faint Infrared Grism Survey*

NASA 2013AB, 2014A Keck Solicitations, \$46250 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Spectroscopically Confirming the Most Distant Galaxies*

NASA 2015A Keck Solicitation, \$16000 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Searching for an Alternative to Lyman alpha: CIII] Emission at $z > 7$*

2012 NASA ADAP Grant, \$130800 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Using Spitzer to Trace the Evolution of Galaxy Stellar Masses*

2012 Hubble Space Telescope, Cycle 20 Archival Grant, \$59950 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Probing the Formation of Dust in the Early Universe*

2012 Hubble Space Telescope, Cycle 20 GO, \$29444 (Finkelstein Co-I)

- *The Cosmic Assembly Near-Infrared Deep Extragalactic Legacy Survey*

2011 Hubble Space Telescope, Cycle 19 E/PO Grant, \$17300 (Finkelstein Co-PI)

- *Exploring the Early Universe at Home and in the Classroom*

2011 Hubble Fellowship, \$103,356

- *Measuring the Evolution of Galaxy Physical Properties from $z = 2 - 8$*

2010 Hubble Space Telescope, Cycle 18 Archival Grant, \$71365 (Finkelstein PI)

- *A Detailed Analysis of Stellar Populations in Galaxies During Reionization*

NASA 2010A, 2010B and 2011A Keck Solicitations, \$41500 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Directly Probing the Star-Forming and Gas Properties of High-Redshift LAEs*

AAS International Travel Grant, Summer 2009, \$1000 (Finkelstein PI)

- Funded travel to France for two conferences on high-redshift galaxies

2009 Galaxy Evolution Explorer, Cycle 5 Archival Grant, \$30000 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Stellar Populations and Large Scale Outflows in GALEX Discovered LAEs*

2008 Hubble Space Telescope, Cycle 16 Archival Grant, \$36133 (Finkelstein PI)

- *Dust Enhancement of the Lyman Alpha Equivalent Width at $z \sim 4.5$ in the CDF-S*

2005-2006 Arizona State University/NASA Space Grant Fellowship, \$16000

Grant Proposals Led by Students or Postdocs Under my Supervision:

JWST Cycle 5 General Observer Grant, \$349,140 (T. Hsiao Science PI, Finkelstein/Chisholm Admin Co-PIs),

- *Aurora's Testimony of Extremely Metal-Poor Galaxies at Cosmic Dawn*

JWST Cycle 5 General Observer Grant, \$54,325 (A. Taylor Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Probing Lyman alpha Escape from a Lyman alpha Emitter Cross at $z=5.7$*

JWST Cycle 4 General Observer Grant, \$181,435 (A. Taylor Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Balmer Breaks in Little Red Dots: Stellar Populations or Dense Neutral Gas?*

JWST Cycle 3 General Observer Grant, \$191,604 (S. Fujimoto Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Panchromatic characterizations of the super-Eddington accretion black hole, host, and environment: Epicenter of red dots, mergers, and dusty starbursts at $z=7.2$*

JWST Cycle 2 General Observer Grant, \$63,617 (S. Fujimoto Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *IFU Trio of ALMA, MUSE, JWST: Revealing Dynamical Interplay of Inflow/Outflow at $z=6$ with Strong Lensing Aid*

NASA 2023A Keck Solicitation, \$28,725 (S. Fujimoto Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Physical Origin of the High $[OIII]88\mu m/[CII]158\mu m$ Ratios in High- z Star-forming Galaxies Uncovered with JWST+ALMA+Keck*

2022 NASA Hubble Fellowship, \$417,215 (S. Fujimoto Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Spectroscopic Confirmation and Characterization of Bright Galaxies at $z \sim 9$*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$143,019 (M. Bagley Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Spectroscopic Confirmation and Characterization of Bright Galaxies at $z \sim 9$*

JWST Cycle 1 General Observer Grant, \$114,627 (M. Bagley Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI),

- *Leveraging Early Public JWST Data to Measure Luminosity Functions and Rest-UV Slopes from $6 < z < 12$*

NASA 2019B Keck Solicitations, \$12,350 (M. Bagley Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *Spectroscopic Characterization of the Brightest Known Galaxy Candidate at $z > 9$*

NASA 2018AB,2019AB Keck Solicitations, \$60,900 (R. Larson Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *Islands of Reionization*

2017 Hubble Cycle 25 AR, \$58,694 (J. Jaacks Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *Simulating pre-galactic metal enrichment for JWST deep-field observations*

2016 Hubble Cycle 24 AR, \$58,696 (J. Jaacks Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *All About That Base: Baseline Metal Enrichment from Population III Star Formation in Cosmological Simulations*

NASA 2016A Keck Solicitation, \$12500 (I. Wold Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *What Makes a Ly α Galaxy a Ly α Galaxy*

2015 Hubble Cycle 23 AR, \$118600 (R. Livermore Science PI, Finkelstein Admin PI)

- *Searching for faint high- z galaxies in the Hubble Frontier Fields*

NASA 2014B Keck Solicitation, \$19000 (Finkelstein Admin PI, Livermore Science PI)

- *Spectroscopic Study of High- z Galaxy Candidates in CANDELS*

INVITED
CONFERENCE
TALKS

Roman Space Telescope Meeting, Pasadena, CA

July 2026

- Invited talk: *Beating Cosmic Variance at Cosmic Dawn with Roman*

MIAPbP, Garching, Germany	June 2026
• Invited talk: <i>The UNICORN Project</i>	
CEERS Team Meeting, Bar Harbor, Maine	May 2026
• Invited talk: <i>The UNICORN Project</i>	
MIT GMT Instrumentation Workshop, Boston, MA	May 2026
• Invited talk: <i>The GMT Science Case</i>	
High-redshift Galaxy formation at the interface between observations and simulations, Kerala, India	January 2026
• Invited talk: <i>The UNICORN Project</i>	
Cosmology Scene Investigation in Sesto, Italy	January 2026
• Invited talk: <i>The UNICORN Project</i>	
The Growth of Galaxies in the Early Universe, Sesto, Italy Jan 2017, 2018, 2019, 2023, 2024, 2025, 2026	
Towards Habitable Worlds, Washington, DC	July 2025
• Invited talk: <i>Doors opened by JWST that HWO can close</i>	
2025 Summer AAS, Fred Kavli Plenary Lectureship, Anchorage, AK	June 2025
• Invited talk: <i>Unveiling the First 500 Myr of the Universe with CEERS</i>	
2024 Tinsley Workshop, Yale University	Oct 2024
• Invited talk: <i>The Abundance of UV-Luminous Galaxies, Massive Galaxies, and SMBHs at Early Times</i>	
Cambridge University Institute of Astronomy 50th Anniversary	July 2024
• Invited talk: <i>Insights into the Early Universe from the First Year of JWST Observations</i>	
National Academy of Sciences Science Week Plenary	March 2023
• Invited talk: <i>Our First Glimpse of the Earliest Galaxies with JWST</i>	
MANIFEST Science Workshop (remote)	April 2023
• Invited talk: <i>Unveiling the Reionization Epoch with Lyα and MANIFEST</i>	
First Science with JWST, Baltimore, MD	December 2022
• Invited talk: <i>The Cosmic Evolution Early Release Science Survey</i>	
Cosmic Dawn with the James Webb Space Telescope, Ringberg, Germany	October 2022
• Invited talk: <i>Pushing Towards the Beginning of Reionization</i>	
CCA Reionization on a Blackboard, NY, NY	September 2022
• Invited talk: <i>Reionization: Ionizing Sources and Impacts of JWST</i>	
Santa Cruz Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, CA	August 2022
• Invited talk: <i>Pushing Towards the Beginning of Reionization</i>	
EAS Annual Meeting	June 2022 *
• *Talk given remotely	
Invited Plenary to the 2020 Canadian Astronomical Society Meeting*	May 2020
• *Meeting cancelled due to COVID-19 pandemic	
JWST Partner's Coordinate Meeting, Redondo Beach, CA	October 2019
• Invited talk to JWST Engineers: <i>Finding the Earliest Galaxies in the Universe with JWST</i>	
BIG EYES ON THE EARLY UNIVERSE, Rome, Italy	September 2019
• Invited talk: <i>Measuring the Evolution of Reionization w/ Big-Glass Observations of Lyα emission</i>	
WFIRST Ultra-Deep Fields, 234th Meeting of the AAS	June 2019
• Invited talk: <i>Constraining Reionization with US-ELT Follow-up of WFIRST Deep Fields</i>	
IAU Symposium 352, Uncovering early galaxy evolution in the ALMA and JWST era	June, 2019

- Invited talk: *Discovery of the Most Distant Star-Forming and Quenched Galaxies in the Early Universe*
- CANDELS @ UMASS, Amherst, MA October, 2018
- Invited talk: *Continuing to Push into the Early Universe with CANDELS*
- Astrophysical Frontiers in the Next Decade and Beyond, Portland, OR June 2018
- Invited talk: *Galaxy Evolution in the Early Universe*
- Sakura CLAW - Cosmic Lyman-alpha Workshop, Tokyo, Japan March 2018
- Invited talk: *First Science with HETDEX*
- GMT Community Science Meeting, Tarrytown, NY September 2017
- Invited talk: *Probing Galaxy Evolution and Reionization with GMT*
- Santa Cruz Galaxy Formation Workshop, Santa Cruz, CA August 2017
- Invited talk: *Reionizing the Universe with Low Escape Fractions*
- Spectral Diagnostics to Explore the Cosmic Dawn with JWST, Baltimore, MD July 2017
- Invited talk: *Ultraviolet Continuum and Ionizing Budget of Galaxies*
- Astronomy in the 2020s: Synergies with WFIRST, Baltimore, MD June 2017
- Invited talk: *A Large-Scale View of the Distant Universe*
- SNOWClaw: Cosmic Lyman Alpha Workshop March 2017
- Invited talk: *The Hobby Eberly Telescope Dark Energy Experiment*
- SANTA CRUZ GALAXY FORMATION WORKSHOP, Santa Cruz, CA August 2016
- Invited talk: *A Realistic Assessment of the Ionizing Budget During Reionization*
- INTERNATIONAL ASTRONOMICAL UNION XXIX August 2015
- Session: Symposium 319: Cosmic Dawn I
- Invited talk: *Understanding Formation and Evolution of Galaxies at Cosmic Dawn*
- INTERNATIONAL ASTRONOMICAL UNION XXIX August 2015
- Session: Focus Meeting: Hubble Frontier Field Galaxies and SNe
- Invited talk: *Probing Bursty Star Formation with the Frontier Fields*
- HUBBLE 25TH ANNIVERSARY SYMPOSIUM, Baltimore, MD April 2015
- Invited talk: *Our First Look into Galaxy Formation with Hubble*
- PHYSICS OF THE HIGH-REDSHIFT UNIVERSE, Edinburgh, UK June 2014
- Invited talk: *Probing the Physics of Galaxy Evolution at $z > 6$*
- THE UNQUIET UNIVERSE, Cefalu, Italy June 2014
- Invited talk: *Spectroscopically Probing the Most Distant Galaxies*
- COSMIC DAWN, Ringberg, Germany June 2013
- Invited talk: *A Full Census of Galaxies in the Distant Universe*
- CCAT HIGH-REDSHIFT GALAXY WORKSHOP, Boulder, CO September 2012
- Invited talk: *Rest-Frame UV Studies of $z > 4$ Galaxies and their Observability with CCAT*
- XTREME ASTROPHYSICS MINI-SYMPOSIUM, Atlanta, GA August 2012
- Invited talk: *The Colors of High-Redshift Galaxies and their Contribution to Reionization*
- 220th MEETING OF THE AAS, Anchorage, AK June 2012
- Special session on Lyman Alpha Emitters, #404.03
- Invited talk: *Using LAEs as Tracers of the High- z Universe*
- 219th MEETING OF THE AAS, Austin, TX January 2012
- Special session on CANDELS, #419.03
- Invited talk: *Probing Galaxy Evolution from $z = 4 - 8$ with CANDELS*
- EXTRAGALACTIC ASTRONOMY WITH GMT, College Station, TX March 2011
- Invited talk: *Hunting the First Galaxies*
- GIANT MAGELLAN TELESCOPE WORKSHOP, Melbourne, Australia June 2010
- Invited review talk: *High- z Galaxies with the Giant Magellan Telescope*

FRANK N. BASH SYMPOSIUM 2009, Austin, TX	October 2009
• Invited review talk: <i>Searching for the First Galaxies</i>	
210th MEETING OF THE AAS, Honolulu, HI	May 2007
• Topical session on Lyman alpha galaxies, #103.04	
• Invited talk: <i>Stellar Populations and Radiative Transfer in Lyman Alpha Galaxies</i>	

INVITED
COLLOQUIA OR
SEMINARS

Carleton College, Sept 2026
 University of Kansas, May 2026
 Colby Collge Colloquium, Oct 2025
 Harvard/CfA Colloquium, Mar 2025
 Northwestern University Colloquium, Feb 2025
 STScI Colloquium, Oct 2024
 Texas A&M University Colloquium, Sept 2024
 University of Minnesota Colloquium, Dec 2023
 Trottier Space Institute Seminar, McGill University, Dec 2023
 Osservatorio Astronomico di Roma Colloquium, July 2023
 Munich Joint Astronomy Colloquium, June 2023
 UC Santa Cruz, Seminar (remote), May 2023
 Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Seminar (remote), March 2023
 Hebrew University of Jerusalem, Seminar (remote), November 2022
 UT Austin Colloquium, September 2022
 Flatiron Institute CCA, Seminar, May 2022
 UC Riverside, Colloquium, April 2022
 Colby College, Colloquium, Sept 2021
 UC Santa Barbara, Colloquium, Dec 2020
 NASA Goddard Space Flight Center, Colloquium, Oct 2020
 Harvard University Center for Astrophysics, Colloquium, May 2019
 University of Arizona, Colloquium, March 2019
 UCLA, Colloquium, Feb 2019
 University of Connecticut, Colloquium, Sept 2018
 University of Copenhagen, DAWN Center Seminar, Jun 2018
 Oxford University, Colloquim, Jan 2018
 University of Sussex, Seminar, Jan 2018
 Space Telescope Science Institute, Special Invited Talk, Mar 2017
 University of California, Berkely, Cosmology Seminar, Feb 2017
 University of Missouri Kansas City Colloquium, Sept 2016
 University of Washington Seminar, July 2016
 New Mexico State University Colloquium, Feb 2016
 NASA Cosmic Origins Science Interest Group Meeting, Jan 2016
 NASA/Goddard ATLAST Seminar, July 2015
 UNLV Physics and Astronomy Forum, April 2013
 MIT Astrophysics Colloquium, April 2013
 NASA/Goddard Astrophysics Colloquium, Dec 2012
 Harvard-CfA ITC Colloquium, Sep 2010
 NASA/Goddard Astronomy Lunch Series, Mar 2009

PROFESSIONAL
EXPERIENCE

Chair, Giant Magellan Telescope Science Advisory Committee (2023–Present)
 Invited Testimony, US House of Representatives (Nov 2022)
 Member, Executive Committee, NASA Cosmic Origins Program Analysis Group (2019–2021)
James Webb Space Telescope Review Panel Vice-Chair, Cycle 4
James Webb Space Telescope Review Panel Member, Cycle 1
 Chair, HETDEX Galaxies and AGN Science Working Group (2019–2020)
 Member, Hubble Space Telescope Users Committee (2019–Present)
 Member, NASA IRTF Keck Users Committee (2018–2021)
 SOC Member, Barefoot Reionization Conference 2019
 Member, NASA Keck Time Allocation Committee (2017–2019)
 Chair, Extragalactic Panel (2018–2019)
 PI, JWST ERS Program (2017–Present)
Hubble Space Telescope Review Panel Member, Cycles 19 & 26
Hubble Space Telescope External Panel Member, Cycles 25 & 27
 Spitzer Cycle 13 Regular and Mid-Cycle DDT Panel – 2017
 Member, NASA Cosmic Origins LUVOIR Science Working Group (2016–2019)
 Member, NASA LUVOIR Optical/NIR Imager instrument team (2016–2019)
 WFIRST Science Investigation Team Member (2016–2020)
 Lead Organizer – South by High Redshift, 2015 international conference at UT Austin
 Organizer – 2014 Texas Astronomy Undergraduate Research Symposium
 Hubble Deep Fields Initiative Committee Member
 Leader of CANDELS High-Redshift Science Working Group
 Referee for Nature, Astrophysical Journal (ApJ), Astrophysical Journal Letters (ApJL),
 Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society (MNRAS), and Astronomy and
 Astrophysics (A&A)
 Lead Author of GMT Science Case First Light and Reionization chapter
 GMT/GMTIFS Instrument Science Team Member
 HET/LRS-2 Instrument Science Team Member
 Member of CANDELS *HST* Multicycle Treasury Program Team
 Member of HETDEX Science Team
 Lead Author of HETDEX White Paper LAE chapter
 External Reviewer, Netherlands Organisation for Scientific Research
 External Reviewer, China Telescope Access Program
 Member of LSST Galaxies Science Collaboration
 Member of Organizing Committee for the 2011 GMT Extragalactic Meeting
 Head of Organizing Committee for the Fall 2010 HETDEX Science Meeting
 Organizer of Texas A&M Morning Astrophysics Coffee 2010–2011
 Creator and Organizer of 1st & 2nd Annual Texas A&M Astrophysics Symposia

DEPARTMENT
SERVICE
EXPERIENCE

Tower Fellows Steering Committee – 2025–Present
 College of Natural Sciences Promotion and Tenure Committee — 2023–Present
 Chair, Faculty Hiring Committee – 2019, 2020, 2023
 Associate Department Chair, Department of Astronomy — 2019–2023
 Chair (Member), Department Peer Teaching Review and Awards Committee — 2018
 (2017) –Present
 Member, HETDEX Survey Steering Committee — 2018–Present
 Chair, McDonald Observatory Faculty Advisory Committee — 2017–Present
 Member, McDonald Observatory Time Allocation Committee — 2017–2019
 Member, Evaluations Committee — 2017–2019

Assistant Graduate Advisor — 2016–2019
 Member, 21st Century Committee for Experiential Education — 2017
 Faculty Sponsor for Astronomy Students Association, UT Austin — 2016 – present
 HET Users Committee, McDonald Observatory, UT Austin — 2015 – present
 Lead Graduate Recruiter, UT Austin — 2014 – 2016
 Cox Endowment Committee Chair, UT Austin — 2014 – 2015
 Graduate Admissions Committee, UT Austin — 2013 – 2016, 2019
 Colloquium Chair, UT Austin — 2012-2013

FUNDRAISING ACTIVITIES

- Keynote speaker at GMT Fundraising Event in May 2026.
- Lectures in Singapore to potential donor prospects in Jan 2026.
- Spoke to UT Tower Fellows in advance of their visit to McDonald Observatory in Nov 2025.
- Co-Hosted a “Salon” on the First Black Holes with UT and McDonald Development in Oct 2025.
- Keynote “Great Lecture” speaker at February 2023 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “Our First Glimpse of the Earliest Galaxies with JWST”, given also as part of 2023 Texas Science Festival. Talk available here: <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=xwjptTzxfQw>
- Invited speaker at inaugural Texas Science Festival in March 2021, titled “Cosmic Beginnings: The Formation of the First Galaxies in the Early Universe”
- Keynote “Great Lecture” speaker at February 2020 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “Pushing the Cosmic Frontier with the Next Generation of Telescopes”
- Held a “Science Discussion Group” at the Feb 2018 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “First Light with the James Webb Space Telescope”, and gave an encore presentation at a fundraising event in Houston two weeks later.
- Held a “Science Discussion Group” at the Feb 2016 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “The James Webb Space Telescope: An Infrared View into the Distant Universe”.
- Held a “Science Discussion Group” at the Feb 2015 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “Cosmic Reionization: How HETDEX Can Help”.
- Traveled with former President Powers to have lunch with a private donor in 2013, ultimately securing a \$1M donation to the Giant Magellan Telescope project.
- Facilitated a meeting between Northrop Grumman executives and the Director of McDonald Observatory, leading to a \$100,000 donation to StarDate Magazine.
- Invited talk at the Feb 2013 McDonald Observatory and Astronomy Department Board of Visitors Meeting in Austin, titled “Creating a Hub for Observing the Distant Universe in Texas”.

GRADUATE STUDENT ADVISING EXPERIENCE	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2024 – Present
	• Advisor of 3rd year graduate student Ansh Gupta, who is studying black holes at early times	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2024 – Present
	• Advisor of 3rd year graduate student Natalia Villanueva, who is studying spatially-resolved properties of high-redshift galaxies.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2021 – July 2026 (PhD)
	• Advisor of graduate student Alexa Morales, who studied the chemical enrichment of galaxies in the early universe.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2020 – June 2026 (PhD)
	• Advisor of graduate student Ó’scar Chávez Ortiz, who studied the physical properties of high-redshift galaxies identified by HETDEX in the <i>Euclid</i> North Ecliptic Pole Deep Field.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2020 – July 2026 (PhD)
	• Advisor of graduate student Katie Chworowsky, who is studying the abundance and properties of massive quiescent galaxies at high redshift.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	July 2019 – December 2021.
	• Advisor of graduate student Adam McCarron, who studied the physical properties of high-redshift galaxies identified by HETDEX.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	June 2016 – May 2023 (PhD)
	• Advisor of graduate student Rebecca Larson, whose thesis included papers on Lyα emission from $z = 7$–9, and the highest-redshift (at the time) AGN from JWST CEERS at $z = 8.7$.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	August 2013 – August 2019 (PhD)
	• Advised graduate student Intae Jung, who led the “Texas Spectroscopic Survey for Lyman alpha Emission in the Epoch of Reionization”, a series of papers on a Keck survey culminating in a measure of the neutral fraction at $z = 7.5$. He went on to a NASA Postdoctoral Program fellow at Goddard Space Flight Center.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	August 2013 – August 2019 (PhD)
	• Advised graduate student Matthew Stevans, who studying the growth of galaxy stellar masses using a 24 deg² <i>K</i>-band imaging survey. He moved into private industry in the Austin area.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	June 2013 – Aug 2018 (PhD)
	• Co-advisor of graduate student Jason Jaacks, who used simulations to study the tracking of galaxy progenitors and descendants, as well as to make predictions for a JWST Deep Field. He received his PhD in June 2018, and is now a Data Scientist at DuPont Pioneer.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	May 2012 – August 2016 (PhD)
	• Advisor of graduate student Mimi Song, who led several projects, culminating the measurement of the stellar mass functions of very high-redshift galaxies. She went on to a NASA Postdoctoral Program fellow at Goddard Space Flight Center.	
POSTDOC ADVISING EXPERIENCE	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2025 – Present
	• Advisor of CFC Fellow Pierluigi Rinaldi, who is working on early black holes and little red dots with JWST.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2025 – Present
	• Co-Advisor of CFC Postdoc Taylor Hutchison, who is working on chemical properties of galaxies with JWST.	
	The University of Texas at Austin	Aug 2025 – Present

- Co-Advisor of CFC Fellow Tiger Hsiao, who is working on primordial galaxies with JWST.
- The University of Texas at Austin Aug 2024 – Present
- Co-Advisor of CFC Fellow (then Hubble Fellow) Vasily Kokorev, who is working on black holes with JWST.
- The University of Texas at Austin Aug 2023 – Present
- Advisor of postdoc Anthony Taylor, who is leading my groups work on spectroscopy with JWST.
- The University of Texas at Austin Aug 2022 – July 2025
- Advisor of Hubble Fellow Seiji Fujimoto, who is working on a variety of JWST and ALMA projects. Moved to Faculty at University of Toronto.
- The University of Texas at Austin October 2020 – August 2024
- Advisor of postdoc Gene Leung, who is leading my groups work on HETDEX in the SHELA and CANDELS fields. Moved to Postdoc at UT Austin.
- The University of Texas at Austin September 2018 – Nov 2024
- Advisor of postdoc Micaela Bagley, who is leading my groups work on the simulations of our JWST ERS science dataset, as well as other investigations into the high-redshift universe with *HST*. Moved to JWST Deputy Project Scientist position at NASA/Goddard.
- The University of Texas at Austin September 2014 – August 2018
- Advisor of postdoc Isak Wold, who built our first photometric catalog in the SHELA field, and studied the evolution of the Ly α luminosity function. He moved on to a NASA/ Postdoctoral Fellowship at Goddard.
- The University of Texas at Austin September 2013 – August 2017
- Advisor of postdoc Rachael Livermore, who led my group's work on the Hubble Frontier Fields. Rachael has developed an innovative technique for subtracting the cluster, allowing for the discovery of fainter galaxies. She moved on to a DECRA Prize Fellowship at the University of Melbourne.

UNDERGRADUATE

STUDENT

ADVISING

EXPERIENCE

I have worked with >40 undergraduate students while at UT Austin, listing below those who completed a research project under my supervision. I denote those who led a publication (*) or a research note ($\dagger$) on our research.

Current Students

- Greta Chubboy (2025–present)
- Kanyuni Iemoto (2025–present)
- Cyril John (2025–present)
- Michael Roshal (2025–present)
- Orion Vasquez (2025–present)
- Daisy Attaway (2024–present)
- Maddie Gerard (2024–present)
- Ananya Gupta (2024–present)
- Abby Kerrigan (2024–present)
- Kyra Sampson (2024–present)

Previous Students

- Gabi Oliva (2025–2026, Masters program at CUNY)
- Adin Viera (2024–2026, Peace Corps)
- Lauren Kokinakis (2023–2026, PhD program at RIT)
- Hannah Lawson (2023–2026, PhD program at UC Santa Barbara)
- Virginia Vanicek (2023–2026, PhD program at Maryland)
- Avery Abramson (2023–2026, Masters program at Texas A&M)

- Emma Tyler (2021-2026)
- Lipika Chatur (2022–2025, PhD program at Arizona)
- Marissa Perry * (2022–2025, PhD program at UW Madison)
- Urvi Thakurdesai * (2022–2025, PhD program at Cambridge)
- Rahul Shaji (2023–2025, Advisory Data Analyst at Aurora Energy Research)
- Arnav Shah (2022–2025)
- Evelyn Allsup (2021–2024, PhD program at Carnegie Mellon)
- Galina Bouyer (2021–2024, UT Dallas postbacc bridge program)
- Sarah Darber (2021–2024, Masters program at Oxford)
- Isaiah Pipkin (2021–2024, Industry)
- Samantha Goldberg (2021–2024, Masters program at Indiana Bloomington)
- Nick Davila (2020-2023, Industry, then Masters program at Georgia Tech)
- Kaile Wang [†] (2021-2023; PhD program at UT Austin)
- Abriana Himantog [†] (2020-2023; PhD program at Wisconsin)
- Thomas Maina (2020-2023)
- Navya Chunduru (2021-2022)
- Valentina Tardugno Poleo* (2020-present; PhD program at NYU, published ApJ paper)
- Sarah Bruce [†] (2020-2022; PhD program at CU Boulder)
- Delaney White (2019-2022; Teach for America, then PhD Program at Cal Tech)
- Aubrey Medrano (2020-21; PhD program at UMass).
- Daniel Mock (2019-21; PhD program at FSU). Research note in prep.
- Isaac Laseter* (2018-2020; PhD program at UW Madison). Paper in prep.
- Sofia Rojas Ruiz* (2016-2019; PhD program at MPIA)
- Alex Sobotka (2017-2018; NRAO, then PhD program at UNC).
- James Diekmann (2013-2015; moved to private industry)

PRESS RELEASES

“Meet the Universe’s Earliest Confirmed Black Hole: A Monster at the Dawn of Time?”

Aug 2025

- Press release on discovery of most distant growing black hole
- <https://news.utexas.edu/2025/07/26/meet-the-universes-earliest-confirmed-black-hole-a-monster-at-the-dawn-of-time/>

“UT’s Cosmic Frontier Center Welcomes New Class of Fellows”

May 2025

- Press release on CFC new class of fellows
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20250520>

“JWST Awards UT Astronomers 10% of Its Coveted Observing Time”

Apr 2025

- Press release based CFC JWST allocations
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20250407>

“AAS Names Steven Finkelstein as Fred Kavli Plenary Lecturer for 246th Meeting” Apr 2025

- Press release on Kavli Lectureship award
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20250404>

“Newfound Galaxy Class May Indicate Early Black Hole Growth”

Jan 2025

- Press release on census of Little Red Dots
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20241023><https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/re>

“Frontier Fellows Tackle Humanity’s Biggest Question: Where Do We Come From?”

Oct 2024

- Press release based on launch of the Cosmic Frontier Center
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20241023>

“Early Galaxies Weren’t Too Big for Their Britches After All”

Aug 2024

- Press release based on high abundance of early massive galaxies.
- <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20240826>

- “Astronomers Confirm Maisie’s Galaxy is Among Earliest Ever Observed” Aug 2023
 - Press release based on confirmation of Maisie’s Galaxy at $z = 11.4$.
 - <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20230814>
- “Webb Telescope Detects Most Distant Active Supermassive Black Hole” July 2023
 - Press release based on identification of a $z \sim 8.7$ AGN from the *JWST* CEERS program.
 - <https://mcdonaldobservatory.org/news/releases/20230706>
- “Wide View of Early Universe Hints at Galaxy Among the Earliest Ever Detected” Aug 2022
 - Press release based on first imaging and early results from *JWST* CEERS program
- “Texas Astronomers Lead Major Projects in James Webb Space Telescope’s First Year” Apr 2021
 - Press release based on awarded *JWST* Cycle 1 Programs
- “Texas Astronomers Will Lead Early Studies with \$8 Billion James Webb Space Telescope” Nov 2017
 - Press release based on awarded *JWST* Early Release Science Program
- “Astronomers Find Faintest Early Galaxies Yet, Probe How the Early Universe Lit Up” Feb 2017
 - Press release based on Hubble Frontier Fields study, the first such study to accurately recover faint galaxies by subtracting the foreground cluster galaxies.
- “Early Galaxies More Efficient at Making Stars, Hubble Survey Reveals” Nov 2015
 - Press release based on CANDELS paper studying the evolution of the UV luminosity function at $z = 4-8$
- “The most distant spectroscopically confirmed galaxy in the universe” Oct 2013
 - We put out a press release based on my nature paper detailing the most distant spectroscopically confirmed galaxy. Myself and my co-authors did several interviews, including on Seattle’s KOMO TV and radio. This story has been published on > 300 news sites around the internet, as well as in several newspapers and magazines (including being the 2nd most-read story on the BBC on the day of the release). I also had several television interviews, including one with CNN International: <http://www.cnn.com/2013/10/23/tech/innovation/most-distant-galaxy/index.html>
- “CANDELS team discovers dusty galaxies at ancient epoch with Hubble Space Telescope” Oct 2012
 - Press release based on CANDELS paper studying the build-up of dust and metals in $z = 4-8$ galaxies

OBSERVING EXPERIENCE

Since 2005, **I have observed ~ 70 nights** using these telescopes/instruments: Keck/MOSFIRE, Keck/NIRSPEC, Keck NIRES, Keck/LRIS, Magellan/MMIRS, Magellan/IMACS, MMT/Megacam, MMT/SWIRC, KPNO 4m/NEWFIRM, KPNO 4m/MOSAIC, CTIO 4m/MOSAIC II, McDonald 2.7m/VIRUS-P and Steward Bok 90”/90 Prime.

SELECTED OBSERVING PROPOSALS LED

- JAMES WEBB SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 5 GO
 - *MIRAGE: MIRI Investigation of Red and Ancient Galaxies in the Early Universe*
 - Awarded 157 prime (plus 120 parallel) hours.
- JAMES WEBB SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 5 GO
 - *The First Stars or the Last Stars: Confirmation of a Robust Candidate $z \sim 30$ Galaxy*
 - Awarded 21 hours.
- KECK 10m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2023
 - *Spectroscopic Exploration of the Early Universe with JWST/CEERS+MOSFIRE*
 - Awarded three nights with MOSFIRE from the NASA TAC.

- HOBBY EBERLY TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) 2021–2022
- *The HET Bright Galaxies in Reionization Survey*
 - Awarded 15 hours (project continued with 22 hours award to a postdoc PI in 2024).
- JAMES WEBB SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 1 GO
- *NGDEEP: The Next Generation Deep Extragalactic Exploratory Public Survey*
 - Awarded 122 prime (plus 90 parallel) hours.
- JAMES WEBB SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 1 GO
- *Confirming a Potential Ultra-Massive Galaxy at $z=10.57$*
 - Awarded 2.6 prime hours.
- GEMINI OBSERVATORY (Finkelstein PI) 2020B
- *Near-infrared Imaging of an Unexpected Sample of Extremely Massive Quiescent Galaxies at $z > 4$*
 - Awarded 19.7 hours (not observed due to COVID-19)
- ALMA OBSERVATORY (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 7
- *Confirming the Quiescent Nature of Massive Galaxies at $z=4$*
 - Awarded 7.7 hours
- HOBBY EBERLY TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) 2018–2021
- *TESLA: The Texas Euclid Survey for Lyman Alpha*
 - Awarded 100 hours.
- HUBBLE SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 27 GO
- *Confirmation of a Large, Robust Sample of $z = 9-10$ Galaxies in the CANDELS Fields*
 - Awarded 14 orbits.
- ALMA OBSERVATORY (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 6
- *Spectroscopic Confirmation of Galaxies in the Reionization Era*
 - Awarded 2.5 hours
- HUBBLE SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 26 Mid-cycle GO
- *Photometric Confirmation of the Brightest Known Galaxy Candidate at $z > 9$*
 - Awarded 2 orbits.
- JAMES WEBB SPACE TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 1 ERS
- *The Cosmic Evolution Early Release Science Survey*
 - Awarded a 63 hour Early Release Science program.
- ALMA OBSERVATORY (Finkelstein PI) Cycle 3
- *Probing the Physics Behind Enhanced Star Formation in the Early Universe*
 - Awarded 2.5 hours
- KPNO 4m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2013 – 2016
- *The NEWFIRM HETDEX Survey - Probing the Growth of Galaxies with Cosmic Time*
 - Awarded a 84 night, four year survey with NEWFIRM.
- KECK 10m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2015
- *A Comprehensive View of Reionization: An Equivalent Width Limited Survey for Lyman Alpha Emission at $z = 6-8$*
 - Awarded one night with MOSFIRE from the NASA TAC.
- SPITZER SPACE TELESCOPE CYCLE 10 GO (Finkelstein PI) 2014
- *Searching for the Brightest Galaxies in the Distant Universe*
 - Awarded 77 hours of IRAC imaging to search for bright $z = 9$ galaxies.
- KECK 10m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Spring 2013, Fall 2013, Spring 2014 & Fall 2015
- *Spectroscopically Confirming the Most Distant Galaxies*

- Awarded six nights with MOSFIRE from the NASA TAC over four runs.

KECK 10m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Spring 2015

- *Searching for an Alternative to Lyman alpha: CIII] Emission at $z > 7$*
- Awarded one night with MOSFIRE from the NASA TAC.

MCDONALD OBSERVATORY 2.7m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Spring 2013

- *Probing Faint LAEs Behind Abell 1689 with VIRUS-P*
- Awarded four nights with VIRUS-P.

KECK 10m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2009, Spring 2010 & Fall 2010

- *Directly Probing the Star-Forming and Gas Properties of High-Redshift LAEs*
- Awarded one-night runs three separate times with NIRSPEC from the NASA TAC.

MAGELLAN 6.5m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2009

- *Spectroscopy of Population III Hosting Galaxies at $z \sim 3.1$ and LAEs at $z \sim 4.5$*
- Awarded two nights with IMACS spectrograph from NOAO TAC.

NOAO-KPNO MAYALL 4m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2008 & 2009

- *Luminosity Function and Evolution of Lyman Alpha Galaxies at $z \sim 2.1$*
- Awarded five nights over two runs with MOSAIC camera.

STEWART OBSERVATORY/SAO MMT (Finkelstein PI) Spring 2009

- *Direct Measurements of Metallicity, Extinction and Outflows of LAEs at $z \sim 0.3$*
- Awarded one night with Hectospec.

NOAO-CTIO BLANCO 4m TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) Fall 2007

- *Dust Enhancement of the Lyman Alpha Equivalent Width at $z \sim 4.5$ in the CDF-S*
- Awarded three nights with MOSAIC II camera.

STEWART OBSERVATORY BOK 90" TELESCOPE (Finkelstein PI) 2007

- *Halo Masses and Clustering Properties of LAEs at $z \sim 3.1$*
- Awarded 13 nights over two runs in Spring and Summer with the 90 Prime camera.

SELECTED TEACHING EXPERIENCE

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Spring 2024, 2025, 2026

- Instructor of AST301-WB, a new 600-student web-based astronomy survey course.

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Fall 2024, 2025

- Instructor of AST376R, Practical Research in Astronomy, an undergraduate course on research methods.

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Spring 2015 & Spring 2023

- Instructor of AST386, a graduate course on galaxy evolution at high redshift.

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Fall 2013, Spring 2014, Fall 2015, Fall 2016, Fall 2017, Fall 2018, Fall 2019, Fall 2020, Spring 2021, Fall 2021, & Fall 2022

- Instructor of AST301, a 200-student astronomy survey course.

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Fall 2018 & Spring 2020

- Instructor of AST376/AST392, a combination hands-on undergraduate/graduate course on techniques in observational astronomy.

INSTRUCTOR, The University of Texas at Austin Spring 2016 & Spring 2017

- Instructor of AST358, an upper-division undergraduate course on galaxies and the universe.

ADJUNCT FACULTY, South Mountain Community College Jan. 2007 – May 2007

- Lead instructor for an introductory astronomy lecture and lab.

TEACHING ASSISTANT, Arizona State University Aug. 2003 – May 2005

- Instructed undergraduate astronomy and physics labs.

SELECTED
OUTREACH
ACTIVITIES

- Public lecture at Carleton College (Chesley Lectureship), *Our Cosmic Origins: Early Galaxies and Black Holes* Sept 2026
- Invited speaker at the Austin Forum July 2024
- Invited speaker at the Capital of Texas Undergraduate Research Conference March 2024
- Invited speaker at the UT Lifetime Learning Program Feb 2022
- Invited speaker at the Houston Space Center for talk on *JWST* Dec 2021
- Invited speaker at the “Keck Observatory Public Talk Series” Sept 2021
- Speaker at ATX Astronomy on Tap 2015, 2016, 2017, 2018, 2019, 2020
- Contributor to NASA Universe of Learning Science Briefing May 2018
- Relativity Lecture Series, Museum of the Southwest November 2014
- I visited Midland, TX in November 2014 to give two invited talks. The first was a lecture in the “Science Friday” series at Midland College on spectroscopy. The second was at the Museum of the Southwest’s “Relativity” lecture series, on my hunt for the most distant galaxies in the universe.
- TV, RADIO & BLOGS 2012 - Present
- Frequent participant in radio and television interviews both on my research, as well as current astronomical topics, appearing multiple times on CNN International TV, Austin’s YNN news and KUT radio, and Seattle’s KOMO news radio. Frequent contributor to the CANDELS collaboration blog (candels-collaboration.blogspot.com), which has received >60,000 views over several countries around the world.
- JWST @ SXSW December 2012 - March 2013
- Assisted with the display of the full-scale JWST model at the SXSW interactive festival in Austin in March 2013. I led the involvement of UT Austin, in collaboration with Northrop Grumman, STScI and NASA. I was responsible for ~25 UT student volunteers, and I gave four public lectures at the model over three days.
- MCDONALD OBSERVATORY TEACHER WORKSHOPS July 2012
- Obtained funding and helped produce a teacher workshop based on galaxy evolution. This included giving a one hour talk to the teachers on my research, helping put on activities, and assisting in nighttime observing.
- TEXAS A&M PHYSICS DAY, Texas A&M University Mar. 2009 & 2010
- 2010: Led children and adults of all ages in making comets out of dry ice.
 - 2009: Led children in an exploration of the curvature of space due to gravity.
- TEXAS A&M ASTRONOMY OPEN HOUSES, Texas A&M University 2009 – 2011
- Presented talks at three public observing nights, one on my research, a more general talk titled “We’re All Made of Stardust,” and on the *HST* Servicing Mission 4.
- SCIENCE BOWL, Texas A&M University Feb. 2009
- I moderated numerous rounds of the Texas A&M high school science bowl, including serving on the panel of experts for the final rounds.
- MONTHLY ASTRONOMY OPEN HOUSE, Arizona State University 2003 – 2008

SELECTED
CONTRIBUTED
TALKS

- Five Questions in Five Days, Aspen, CO Mar 2026
- Barefoot Reionization, Fitzroy Island, Australia July 2019

Massively Parallel Large Area Spectroscopy from Space, Pasadena, CA	October 2018
Distant Galaxies from the Far South, Bariloche, Argentina	December 2017
Exploring the Universe with JWST II, Montreal, Canada	October 2016
Signals from the Deep Past: Unveiling Early Cosmic Structures, Malta	July 2016
Signals from the Deep Past: Unveiling Early Cosmic Structures, Malta	July 2016
The Reionization Epoch: New Insights and Future Prospects, Aspen, CO	June, 2015
Reionization: A Multiwavelength Approach, South Africa	June, 2015
South by High Redshift, Austin, TX	April, 2015
Yale Frontier Fields Workshop, New Haven, CT	November 2014
The formation and growth of galaxies, Obergurgl, Austria	April 2014
First Annual GMT Community Workshop, Chicago, IL	June 2013
HETDEX Team Meeting, Potsdam, Germany	May 2013
CANDELS Team Meeting, UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA	Sept 2012
First Stars IV, Kyoto, Japan	May 2012
CANDELS Team Meeting, Leiden University, Leiden, Netherlands	Feb 2012
New Horizons at High Redshift, University of Cambridge, Cambridge, UK	July 2011
CANDELS High-Redshift Meeting, Sesto, Italy	June 2011
217th Meeting of the AAS, Seattle, WA	Jan. 2011
Seminar, University of Washington, Seattle, WA	Jan. 2011
Seminar, Carnegie Observatories, Pasadena, CA	Nov. 2010
Seminar, University of California, Los Angeles, CA	Nov. 2010
Seminar, University of Massachusetts, Amherst, MA	Sep. 2010
Seminar, New York University, New York, NY	Sep. 2010
First Stars and Galaxies Conference, Austin, TX	Mar. 2010
The High-Redshift Universe Conference, Aspen, CO	Feb. 2010
The Lyman Alpha Universe IAP Colloquium, Paris, France	Jul. 2009
Understanding Lyman Alpha Emitters Conference, Heidelberg, Germany	Oct. 2008
211th Meeting of the AAS, Austin, TX	Jan. 2008

Summary: ~ 452 papers published in or submitted to peer-reviewed journals, with an h-index of 99. Citation counts as of October 1, 2026.

REFEREED
PUBLICATIONS:
FIRST AUTHOR
(25 PAPERS, 4,895
CITATIONS)

1. Finkelstein, S. L., Bagley, M. B., Arrabal Haro, P. et al. **2025**, *The Cosmic Evolution Early Release Science Survey (CEERS)*, ApJL, 983, 4 [169 citations]
2. Finkelstein, S. L., Leung, G. C. K., Bagley, M. B., et al. **2024**, *The Complete CEERS Early Universe Galaxy Sample: A Surprisingly Slow Evolution of the Space Density of Bright Galaxies at $z \sim 8.5\text{--}14.5$* , ApJL, 969, L2 [303 citations]
3. Finkelstein, S. L., Bagley, M. B., Ferguson, H. C., et al. **2023**, *CEERS Key Paper. I. An Early Look into the First 500 Myr of Galaxy Formation with JWST*, ApJL, 946, L13 [677 citations]
4. Finkelstein, S. L. et al. **2022**, *A Long Time Ago in a Galaxy Far, Far Away: A Candidate $z \sim 12$ Galaxy in Early JWST CEERS Imaging*, Astrophysical Journal Letters, 940, 55 [412 citations]
5. Finkelstein, S. L. and Bagley, M. **2022**, *On the Co-Evolution of the AGN and Star-Forming Galaxy Ultraviolet Luminosity Functions at $3 < z < 9$* , Astrophysical Journal, 938, 25 [82 citations]
6. Finkelstein, S. L. et al. **2022**, *A Census of the Bright $z = 8.5\text{--}11$ Universe with the Hubble and Spitzer Space Telescopes*, Astrophysical Journal, 928, 52 [142 citations]
7. Finkelstein, S. L. et al. **2019**, *Conditions for Reionizing the Universe with A Low Ionizing Photon Escape Fraction*, Astrophysical Journal, 879, 36 [395 citations]
8. *Invited Review Article:* Finkelstein, S. L. **2016**, *Observational Searches for Star-Forming Galaxies at $z > 6$* , Publications of the Astronomical Society of Australia, 33, 37 [164 citations]
9. Finkelstein, S. L., Song, M., Behroozi, P. et al. **2015**, *An Increasing Stellar Baryon Fraction in Bright Galaxies at High Redshift*, Astrophysical Journal, 814, 95 [73 citations]
10. Finkelstein, S. L., Ryan R, Papovich, C. et al. **2015**, *The Evolution of the Galaxy Rest-Frame Ultraviolet Luminosity Function over the First Two Billion Years*, Astrophysical Journal, 810, 71 [736 citations]
11. Finkelstein, S. L., Papovich, C., Dickinson, M., et al. **2013**, *The Discovery of a Rapidly Star-forming Galaxy 700 Million Years After the Big Bang at $z = 7.51$* , Nature, 502, 524 [249 citations]
12. Finkelstein, S. L., Papovich, C., Ryan, R., Pawlik, A., Dickinson, M., Ferguson, H., Finlator, K., Koekemoer, A., Giavalisco, M. and the CANDELS Team **2012**, *CANDELS: The Contribution of the Observed Galaxy Population to Cosmic Reionization*, Astrophysical Journal, 758, 93 [203 citations]
13. Finkelstein, S. L., Papovich, C., Salmon, B., Finlator, K., Dickinson, M., Ferguson, H., Giavalisco, M., Koekemoer, A., Reddy, N. and the CANDELS Team **2012**, *CANDELS: The Evolution of Galaxy Rest-Frame Ultraviolet Colors from $z = 8 - 4$* , Astrophysical Journal, 756, 164 [332 citations]

14. Finkelstein, S. L., Cohen, S. H., Windhorst, R. A., Ryan, R. E., Hathi, N. P., Finkelstein, K. D. and the WFC3 ERS Team **2011**, *Hubble Space Telescope Imaging of Lyman Alpha Emission at $z = 4.4$* , Astrophysical Journal, 735, 5 [42 citations]
15. Finkelstein, S. L., Cohen, S. H., Moustakas, J., Malhotra, S., Rhoads, J. E. & Papovich, C. **2011**, *Dust Extinction and Metallicities of Star-Forming Lyman Alpha Emitting Galaxies at Low Redshift*, Astrophysical Journal, 733, 117 [48 citations]
16. Finkelstein, S. L., Hill, G. J. & Gebhardt, K. et al. **2011**, *The HETDEX Pilot Survey III: The Low Metallicities of High-Redshift Lyman Alpha Galaxies*, Astrophysical Journal, 729, 140 [112 citations]
17. Finkelstein, S. L., Papovich, C., Giavalisco, M., Reddy, N., Ferguson, H., Koekoer, A. & Dickinson, M. **2010**, *On the Stellar Populations and Evolution of Star-Forming Galaxies at $6.3 < z < 8.6$* , Astrophysical Journal, 719, 1250 [207 citations]
18. Finkelstein, S. L., Cohen, S. H., Malhotra, S., Rhoads, J. E., Papovich, C., Zheng, Z., Wang, J. **2009**, *A Plethora of AGN Among Lyman Alpha Galaxies at Low Redshift*, Astrophysical Journal, 703, L162 [31 citations]
19. Finkelstein, S. L., Papovich, C., Rudnick, G., Egami, E., Le Floch, E., Rieke, M., Rigby, J. & Willmer, C. **2009**, *Turning Back the Clock: Inferring the History of the 8 O'clock Arc*, Astrophysical Journal, 700, 376 [47 citations]
20. Finkelstein, S. L., Cohen, S., Malhotra, S. & Rhoads, J. E. **2009**, *Evolution of Lyman Alpha Galaxies: Stellar Populations at $z \sim 0.3$* , Astrophysical Journal, 700, 276 [35 citations]
21. Finkelstein, S. L., Malhotra, S., Rhoads, J. E., Hathi, N. P. & Pirzkal, N. **2009**, *The Expected Detection of Dust Emission from High-Redshift Lyman Alpha Galaxies*, Monthly Notices of the Royal Astronomical Society, 393, 1174 [25 citations]
22. Finkelstein, S. L., Rhoads, J. E., Malhotra, S. & Grogin, N. **2009**, *Lyman Alpha Galaxies: Primitive, Dusty or Evolved?*, Astrophysical Journal, 691, 465 [155 citations]
23. Finkelstein, S. L., Rhoads, J. E., Malhotra, S., Grogin, N. & Wang, J. **2008**, *Effects of Dust Geometry in Lyman Alpha Galaxies at $z = 4.4$* , Astrophysical Journal, 678, 655 [108 citations]
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